Here are the step-by-step student instructions designed for a web-based workflow (using GitHub in the browser), avoiding any terminal commands while addressing the folder-structure challenge directly.

Step 1: Create Your Repository

1. Log in to your GitHub.com account.
2. In the top-right corner of the page, click the `+` icon and select **New repository**.
3. Fill in the repository settings:
    1. **Repository name:** `DATA 205 Capstone Project - Fall 2026`
    2. **Description:** `Capstone project repository for DATA 205.`
    3. **Visibility:** Choose **Public** (or Private, depending on course requirements).
    4. **Initialize this repository:** Check the box to **Add a README file**. *(Crucial: This instantly creates your main branch so you can add folders right away).*
4. Click the green **Create repository** button at the bottom.

Step 2: Edit Your `README.md` File

1. You are now looking at your repository's homepage, where you should see your newly created `README.md` file listed.
2. Click on the `README.md` file name to open it.
3. In the top-right corner of the file view, click the **Pencil icon** ("Edit this file") to open the web editor.
4. Add some initial text to your README, for example:

```markdown
# DATA 205 Capstone Project - Fall 2026

## Student Name: [Your Name Here]

### Project Overview
Welcome to my capstone project repository. This workspace will house my data ing
```

5. Scroll down to the **Commit changes...** box at the bottom:
    1. **Commit message:** Type `Initialize README with project overview`.
    2. Leave the radio button selected for *"Commit directly to the `main` branch"*.

6. Click the green **Commit changes** button.

Step 3: Build the Placeholder Directory Structure

*Remember: GitHub doesn't save empty folders. To make our folder structure appear, we will use the **"Slash Trick"** to create a placeholder file inside each required directory.*

1. Return to your repository's main page by clicking the repository name (`DATA 205 Capstone Project - Fall 2026`) at the top left.
2. Click the green `<> Code` button, then click **Add file** → **Create new file**.
3. In the **Name your file...** box, type the exact folder path followed by a placeholder file name using this pattern:
    1. `Project Plan/.gitkeep` *(Typing* `Project Plan/` *automatically generates the folder).*
4. Scroll to the bottom and click **Commit changes**.
5. Repeat this process for the remaining directories by clicking **Add file** → **Create new file** for each:
    1. `Data/.gitkeep`
    2. `Ingestion/.gitkeep`
    3. `EDA/.gitkeep`
    4. `Analysis/.gitkeep`
    5. `Models/.gitkeep`
    6. `Interim Project Report/.gitkeep`
    7. `Final Project Report/.gitkeep`

    Verification: Once finished, return to your main repository page. You should now see a clean, professional folder structure ready to house your capstone components without needing a terminal or local command line.